

Shenkai Wu

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EDUCATION

Brandeis University, Waltham, MA

08/2022 - 05/2027 (expected)

- Ph.D. International Economics and Finance

Research Interest: International Finance, Corporate Finance, Cybersecurity, Annuity

Coursework: Corporate Finance, Asset Pricing, Fixed Income, Derivatives, Advanced Econometrics, Time Series, Advanced Quantitative Analysis in Finance, Information Visualization

Columbia University, New York, NY

08/2020 - 12/2021

- M.A. Economics

Shanghai University of International Business and Economics, Shanghai, China

09/2016 - 06/2020

- B.A. Finance (with honors)

WORKING PAPER

Is Equity Return Affected by Country or by Industry?

• Country and industry affiliation are commonly used to account for the relative performance of stocks. These two factors usually co-moves and mutually contributes to the equity returns. This paper extracts the effect of 15 country and 11 industry dynamics and calculates the relative importance of them on the stock return volatility. Results are presented as ratios, which is country or industry related volatility to the total volatility. In the latest data, country and industry dynamics both account for half of the volatility. The narrowing gap in the past twenty years between these two factors implies the achievement of globalization.

WORK IN PROGRESS

State Deals, Hacker Meals: Do Government Contractors Attract the Attention of Cyber Threat Actors?

with Jiaying Huang, Aldo Musacchio, Debarshi Nandy, Anna Scherbina

• Firms improve financial transparency to win government contracts, but this increased disclosure also heighten the firm's visibility to external actors, including adversaries. SecureBERT and LLM API are used to classify historical cyber attack cases. Then we conducted a staggered DiD analysis on cyber attack data to test whether firms experience more attacks after receiving their first government contract, compared with their peer firms.

INTERNSHIPS

China Securities Co., Ltd., Shanghai, China

12/2019 - 01/2020

Intern, Investment Banking Department

- Archived the relevant documents after the corporate bond issuance of an infrastructure company to facilitate the follow-up work
- Assisted in writing working papers of M&A of an automobile component manufacturing company

Softbank China Venture Capital, Shanghai, China

07/2019

Intern, Post-Investment Management Department

- Assisted in the due diligence of an invested textile company, evaluated the company's profitability by analyzing its joint ventures' articles of association, financial statements, and other materials
- Wrote research reports on the quality and cost of dyeing to facilitate the strategic development of the funded company

KPMG, Shanghai, China

01/2019 - 03/2019

Intern, Audit Department

- Implemented on-site due diligence on a pre-IPO internet company, responsible for vouching, data acquisition, supervising and product testing
- Prepared, sent and tracked audit confirmation letters, and followed up on outstanding confirmations

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Adjunct Professor

- Financial Management

Brandeis University
Summer 2024 - Summer 2026

Teaching Assistant

- Introduction to Macroeconomics with Mahsa Akbari
- Transfer Pricing with Shanto Ghosh
- Options & Derivatives with Robert R. Reitano
- Econometrics with Yinchu Zhu

Brandeis University
Spring 2026
Fall 2023 - Fall 2025
Fall 2025
Spring 2024

SCHOLARSHIPS AND HONORS

- Brandeis PhD Full Scholarship 2022 - 2027
- SUIBE Academic Merit Scholarship 2018 - 2020

SKILLS

- Languages: Mandarin (native), English (fluent)
- Statistical Analysis Tools: Stata, Python, R, SAS, L^AT_EX, GitHub
- Database: Compustat, CRSP, Bloomberg, S&P Capital IQ

REFERENCES

Daniel Bergstresser
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Brandeis University
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Anna Scherbina
Janet L. Yellen Distinguished Professor
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